

The Psychology of Men Who Are Both Rich and Jacked EP 308

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jun 19, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tjil4yLmxzs> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter (27 years training, 43 years old) breaks down 5 things he'd do differently starting his fitness journey today — from AI-powered macro tracking to NEAT calorie burning — plus a stock market segment with trader Greg.

Contents

-  Intro & Sponsors
-  Lesson 1: Track Macros & Calories From Day One
-  How to Track Calories With AI (Claude/ChatGPT)
-  Market Recap with Greg (Victory Trades)
-  Lesson 2: Full-Body Workouts Beat Bro Splits
-  Lesson 3: Prioritize NEAT Over Traditional Cardio
-  Lesson 4: Split Your Workouts Into Multiple Short Sessions
-  Lesson 5: Track How Many Calories You Burn Daily
-  Mindset: Standards vs. Ambition

Intro & Sponsors 0:55

- Episode 308 of the Victory Talk Podcast, hosted by Brandon Carter ("King Keto, Gymnasium Jesus")
- Co-host DJ Chita Grande monitors the chat and reads Super Chats
- **Three pillars of the show:** money, muscle, and mindset
- Sponsors announced:
 - **Free live training on June 28th, 2 p.m. EST** — how to grow an online fitness business using AI
 - Student examples cited:
 - Jen: \$33,000 in under 2 months, while working full-time with 2 kids and a husband (later noted she made \$110,000 in one month)
 - Will (DC): \$52,000 in his first 4 months
 - Angelo (full-time trucker, 80 hrs/week): reached \$10,000–\$11,000/month in just 6 weeks; now considering quitting trucking
 - Link: first link in description; register for free

- **Sales team hiring** — appointment setter/entry-level sales roles at High Ticket Trainer
 - Third link in description; fill out TypeForm application
 - Work-from-home, flexible hours; quota based on dials and appointments booked
 - No experience required for entry level
- **One-on-one online training** — Brandon taking a handful of clients this summer
 - Services: macro tracking, meal plan, training plan, daily accountability
 - Second link in description; must reply to follow-up text message to be considered
- **Thot Repellent** — a comedic crowdfunded product; all Super Chats go toward it; target launch: July 4th
- Book shout-out: *Awaken the Giant Within* by Tony Robbins — in Brandon's top 5 reading recommendations

Lesson 1: Track Macros & Calories From Day One 946

- Brandon trained for his **first 2 years without tracking** — calls it his biggest regret
 - Excuse at the time: no smartphones in the late 1990s/early 2000s
 - Eventually switched to handwritten notebooks, then MyFitnessPal (used for 10+ years), now AI tools
- **Core claim:** Tracking is the single most important dietary habit; people on steroids still look bad without it
 - "You can't out-train a bad diet. You can't out-drug a bad diet."
- **Duke University study cited:**
 - Participants told NOT to change their diet or exercise habits at all
 - Only instruction: start tracking calories
 - Result: lost an average of **5 lbs over 3 months** with zero intentional effort
 - Mechanism: tracking makes you more cognizant of intake, leading to intuitive better choices
- Analogy: not tracking calories is like running a business without accounting — "you gonna be bankrupt"

Calorie & Protein Targets:

Goal	Calories	Protein
Cut (lose fat)	Bodyweight (lbs) × 10	1g per lb of bodyweight
Bulk (gain muscle)	Bodyweight (lbs) × 20	1g per lb of bodyweight

- Fats vs. carbs: Brandon doesn't care which you prioritize — "calories and protein are what really matters for body composition"
- Brandon has been **ketogenic for 11 consecutive years** — reasons beyond body composition:
 - Keto shown to cure acne (his skincare routine: "Nothing. Keto.")
 - Improved immune system — hasn't had a cold in 11 years
 - But emphasizes: keto is not required; hit calories and protein however you like



How to Track Calories With AI (Claude/ChatGPT) 1471

- Brandon has shifted from MyFitnessPal to **Claude (Anthropic)** as his primary tracking method
 - Claims it's more effective and easier than MyFitnessPal
- **How it works — step by step:**
 - Use a long custom prompt (DM Brandon "tracking" on Instagram to receive it automatically)
 - Type or photograph each meal and input it into Claude
 - Claude estimates calories, protein, carbs, and fats per meal
 - Provides a **running daily total** after each entry
 - Claude syncs with **Apple Health** (via connected wearable) to pull calories burned
 - Calculates and displays your **current caloric deficit or surplus** in real time
- **Photographing food instead of weighing:**
 - Brandon still weighs food with a small digital scale (carries it everywhere)
 - At a catered barbecue where scale wasn't practical: photographed plates of food
 - Photo-based estimates are "within acceptable range" though less accurate than a scale
 - Simply upload image; Claude estimates portion size and macros
- **Protein shake example:** photographed the label, uploaded to Claude — macros read directly
- **Apple Health / wearable integration:**
 - Claude can sync with Apple Health; ChatGPT cannot (at time of recording)
 - Works with: Oura Ring (Brandon's preference), Whoop, Garmin, Apple Watch
 - If not on Apple device: DM "tracking" and Brandon sends alternate ChatGPT prompt
- **Fat loss math reinforced:**
 - 1 lb of fat = 3,500 calories
 - To lose 2 lbs/week → must maintain a **1,000 calorie/day deficit** ($1,000 \times 7 = 7,000$ calories)
- Sample day Brandon described:
 - Denver omelette (4 oz) + 2 oz salmon → running total logged
 - Protein shake → photographed label, macros auto-read
 - Catered BBQ vegetables → photographed plates
 - End of day: ~3,000 calories burned, ~1,000 calorie deficit, **240g protein, ~2,000 calories consumed**



Market Recap with Greg (Victory Trades) 1942

- Guest: Greg ("Young Candlestick"), Chartered Market Technician (CMT designation — passed four 3-hour exams, board approved, research published)
- **Broad market:**
 - Market in "summer chop" — higher lows, lower highs; unlikely to sell off hard or rally big
 - Fed: new chair Worsh stated "inflation is a choice" → caused a sell-off, then rebounded

- Best opportunities currently in **futures trading and individual stocks**
- MAG7 stocks weak; **semiconductors hitting new all-time highs**
- Next week could be a "strangle" setup: buy a call + buy a put, cut the loser, ride the winner
- **Individual stock picks:**
 - **TSM (TSMC):** breaking out on high volume — "spam call options, buy dips"; member made \$333 in 20 minutes (doubled money); straight call option = 10x (\$80 → \$1,000)
 - **NBIS:** called when stock was at \$80–90, now ~\$300 (tripled); Greg still bullish, target is 10x; buy the trend line break
 - **SpaceX:** 175 dip buy — 10% gain if entered Monday, 40% Tuesday, 100% by recording day; sell bullish put credit spreads at key support
 - **Google:** Greg's preferred stock; not at all-time highs while NASDAQ is — sees it as undervalued
 - **Apple:** bearish flag but above prior all-time highs
 - **Microsoft:** underperforming; Greg bought dip at \$420, underwater; stop loss at \$356; volume spike + hammer candle = possible buy
 - **Amazon:** Greg made money earlier, then bought at \$260; now at \$244; still likes long-term; December call spreads with entry over \$246
 - **Honeywell:** called at \$220, now \$230; breakout buy target over \$235
 - **TTWO (GTA 6 play):** rangebound but breaking out on volume; entry "right now"
 - **HIMS:** called breakout over \$30; up 25% in 4 days
 - **XLFF (Financials ETF):** up ~4% YTD, underperforming; use as S&P indicator; dip buy at \$52.50
 - **XLE (Energy ETF):** up ~20% YTD vs. S&P ~5–6% (outperforming by ~4x); thesis: AI is energy-hungry + regional conflict supports oil; wheeling 100 shares; if drops to \$49–50, buy LEAP calls
 - XLE went sideways for 7 years → "length of consolidation = length of breakout" → potential 7-year uptrend
 - **CIFR:** called at \$20, now \$30 (up 50%); still riding call spreads
 - **Bitcoin:** Greg strongly advises staying away; has been in a downtrend; "let it break the downtrend before buying"
 - Brandon has a friend who put \$100k into Bitcoin at \$100,000–\$110,000
- **Key trading principles from Greg:**
 - Buy breakouts on **high volume**; pull back on lighter volume = wait for next curl
 - Use **relative strength vs. S&P** indicator: bottom-left to top-right = buy; top-left to bottom-right = short candidate
 - Know when NOT to trade — choppy days, no setup = shut the computer; "less trading is statistically better"
 - Don't revenge trade losses; don't overtrade winners past profit goals

- Track trades: entry, stop loss, setup — "what gets measured gets managed"
- Swing trade alerts don't require instant entry; **day trade alerts must be acted on within 1–2 minutes**
- **Victory Trades membership:**
 - Includes: trade alerts to phone, live futures trading (NASDAQ futures every morning), 80+ hours of beginner courses, options course
 - Greg pays \$350/month for investment research; brings it into Victory Trades
 - Brandon planning to get Bloomberg Terminal (\$3,000/month)
 - Trade with Apex funded accounts (use code "victory trades"); no PDT rule
 - Brandon made \$15,000 in 10 trading days live; Prey makes \$4,000–\$5,000/day
 - Over 40 reviews, 4.85 stars
 - Recent member wins: SMH spread up 74% (7.4× S&P alpha); NBIS 240% (\$140 → \$500); QQQ put 76% gain; \$920 futures payout
 - Link in description

Lesson 2: Full-Body Workouts Beat Bro Splits 4193

- Brandon's strong conviction: **full-body workouts are superior to splits**
 - Acceptable splits: upper/lower body, push/pull/legs ("about as far as I'd go")
- **Volume comparison — Bro Split vs. Full-Body (4x/week):**

Metric	Bro Split	Full-Body (4x/week)
Chest sets per session	16 (4 exercises × 4 sets)	8 (2 exercises × 4 sets)
Chest sets per week	16	32
Chest sets per year (52 weeks)	832	1,664

- Full-body guy gets **twice the sets** per week and **twice as many per year**
- **Quality advantage — compound vs. isolation movements:**
 - Full-body prescription: **only compound (multi-joint) movements**
 - Bro splits typically include many isolation movements (e.g., cable crossovers, dumbbell flies) — less effective for muscle growth
 - Compound movements: bench press, incline press, bent-over rows, pull-ups, chin-ups, squats, leg press, lunges, overhead press, deadlifts
 - Isolation movements reserved for **extremities only**: biceps, triceps, calves (hard to compound-train these)
 - Exception: physique competitors/bikini models may need isolation work for detail
- **Protein synthesis argument:**
 - Muscle growth (protein synthesis) lasts **~48 hours** after resistance training
 - Bro split: hit chest once → **5 days of missed growth potential**

- Full-body / upper-lower: muscles stay in a **constant state of protein synthesis** all week
- Historical note: splits were **invented for steroid users** — before steroids, ALL bodybuilders did full-body workouts

"I didn't start to put on a good amount of size until I started doing full-body workouts. When I did full-body, that's when things went to the next level."

- Full-body prescription summary:
 - 4 days/week
 - 1–2 exercises per body part
 - 3–4 sets each
 - Compound movements only (except extremities)

Lesson 3: Prioritize NEAT Over Traditional Cardio 4774

- **How the body burns calories — 4 components:**

Component	Description	% of Total Calories Burned
BMR (Basal Metabolic Rate)	Calories burned just keeping you alive (organs, blood, breathing)	~60%
Thermic Effect of Food	Calories burned digesting food	~20%
EAT (Exercise Activity Thermogenesis)	Calories burned from actual workouts	~5%
NEAT (Non-Exercise Activity Thermogenesis)	Calories burned from everyday movement	~10% (can be raised significantly)

- **Why cardio is overrated for fat loss:**
 - Average person burns only ~100 calories per mile run — "almost nothing; there's more than 100 calories in a handful of almonds"
 - High-intensity cardio spikes **leptin and ghrelin** (hunger hormones) → makes you hungrier → easy to eat back all the calories burned
 - High-intensity cardio stresses the **central nervous system** → impairs weight room performance → reduces muscle gain → lowers BMR (the biggest calorie-burning lever)
 - Body seeks **homeostasis**: if you do a ton of sprints, your body makes you lazier/more tired throughout the day to compensate
- **Why NEAT is superior for fat loss:**
 - Doesn't spike hunger hormones
 - Doesn't stress the CNS or joints

- Can be **dramatically increased**: average person takes 4,000–5,000 steps/day; bumping to **20,000 steps/day** burns an extra **~1,000 calories/day** (for someone Brandon's size) with zero recovery cost
- NEAT can realistically be raised from ~10% to **25–30%** of total daily calorie burn
- **NEAT strategies Brandon uses:**
 - **Morning walk** — over 1 mile along the Atlantic Ocean every morning
 - **Desk bike (exercise bike)**: pulled up to standing desk during low-cognitive-demand meetings; on heavy meeting days (e.g., Mondays) can accumulate **hours of low-intensity pedaling**
 - **Deliberate walking**: walks anywhere within walking distance instead of car/Uber
 - Takes stairs; takes the long way
 - **Trampoline park with his son** — burns significant calories and counts as fun NEAT
- **Tools:**
 - Desk bike / exercise bike (preferred over walking pad — avoids falls and doesn't break concentration)
 - Walking pad / treadmill desk (effective but Brandon has fallen off while working)
- **Real-world evidence:**
 - Cities (NYC, Miami) have far fewer obese people than suburbs/rural areas — not just workout culture, but **walkability = more NEAT**
 - Data suggests city dwellers live longer; Brandon attributes this largely to more daily walking
- Conclusion: "When people ask what's the best cardio to burn fat — move more throughout the day. That's it."

Lesson 4: Split Your Workouts Into Multiple Short Sessions [5706](#)

- **Origin story:** When Brandon lived in Queens and commuted to Manhattan, he stopped at the gym for 30 minutes before work and 30 minutes after — totaling 60 minutes, same as before
 - Noticed he was **less exhausted** after just 30 minutes and his second session felt as fresh as the first
- **Core principle:** The first half of any workout is always more intense than the second half — regardless of fitness level
 - Example: Victor Wembanyama (young, elite, defensive player of the year) was still visibly tired in the fourth quarter of the NBA Finals
 - Splitting the workout gives you **"two first halves"** — you're fresh at the start of each session
- **Progression:**
 - Queens → Manhattan: **2 sessions × 30 minutes**
 - Manhattan (lived 1 block from Equinox): **3 sessions × 20 minutes**
 - Session 1: upon waking
 - Session 2: around lunch
 - Session 3: end of day
 - Total: still just 60 minutes — but dramatically better results

- **Bonus benefit:** Avoided the post-workout energy crash that impairs work performance
 - Referenced Alex Hormozi complaining about being exhausted after big leg days
 - Brandon's solution: "Split it up — I'm not exhausted after 30 minutes. I work normally. Body recovers. Then I hit the second half fresh."
- **Caveat:** Brandon acknowledges this is "bro science" — no studies to cite; based purely on personal experience and logical reasoning
 - Analogy: boxer with more energy in round 1 than round 12 — if you rest between rounds 6 and 7, you're fresh again
- **If you can't get to the gym multiple times:**
 - Buy home equipment: adjustable dumbbells (up to 100 lbs), a weight bench, a pull-up bar
 - Do half the workout at home (upper body), go to gym for the other half (squats, heavy lower body)
 - Brandon uses the gym in his condo building — "just go downstairs"



Lesson 5: Track How Many Calories You Burn Daily 6133

- **The missing half of the equation:** Most people track what they eat but not what they burn
 - "You got to burn more than you consume — but how do you know if you're in a deficit if you're not tracking the burn?"
- **Recommended wearables:** Oura Ring (Brandon's preference), Apple Watch, Whoop, Fitbit, Garmin, Samsung Watch
 - Brandon uses Oura Ring primarily for **calorie burn tracking** (not sleep, which he's "got figured out")
- **None of these devices are 100% accurate** — but that's okay:
 - Use the data to **establish a range** and calibrate over time
 - If your device says you're burning 4,000 calories/day (Brandon's reading) but you're not losing 2 lbs/week on a 2,000-calorie diet, you know the device is overshooting — adjust accordingly
 - Once calibrated, it becomes simple math
- **Fat loss math:**
 - 1 lb fat = 3,500 calories
 - 2 lbs/week loss = **1,000 calorie/day deficit** × 7 days = 7,000 calories
- **How the Claude AI prompt ties this together:**
 - At end of each meal log, Claude pulls Apple Health data from the wearable
 - Shows: calories consumed so far + calories burned so far = **real-time deficit/surplus**
 - Brandon can see throughout the day whether he's on track
- **Why this matters for staying lean in your 40s:**
 - Brandon credits this system as the **main reason he stays "ripped and shredded year-round" in his mid-40s**
 - "It's hard to get fat when you have this data. It's hard not to get ripped if you're doing everything right."

Mindset: Standards vs. Ambition 6608

- **Super chat question:** "I always perform great when in survival mode, but as soon as things get good, I start messing up. A lifelong pattern. How do I solve this?"
- Brandon's diagnosis: **You don't rise to your ambitions — you fall to your standards**
 - Common pattern among his business students: hit a peak income → get complacent → stop doing what worked → income drops → hit rock bottom standard → grind back up → repeat cycle indefinitely
 - The floor (standard) is what actually drives behavior, not the ceiling (ambition)
- **The fix: raise your standards, not your goals**
 - Instead of "I want to make \$10K/month" → shift to **"I will make no less than \$10K/month"**
 - Standards are non-negotiable minimums; when you approach them, you automatically change behavior
 - Continuously increase the standard floor over time
- Some people deliberately put themselves in financial pressure (buy a car they can't afford, get a place they can't afford) to recreate survival mode — Brandon doesn't recommend this
 - Better path: consciously define and raise your standards without manufacturing a crisis
- Brandon has been coaching online fitness business growth for **~9 years** and has seen this pattern "a bunch of times"